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South & SE Asia Consumer Tech

Sea Ltd

Rating

Outperform

Price Target



150.00 USD

Sea Ltd: E-commerce battle continues, but the noise is fading

How fierce is e-commerce competition in Southeast Asia? We present thoughts based on the latest on-the-ground checks.

Our proprietary pricing tracker, which follows a fixed basket of products across platforms, continues to point to an industry choosing discipline over disruption. March quarter, prices rose broadly as merchants grappled with higher logistics costs. Importantly, both Shopee and TikTok Shop moved in the same direction. Rather than fighting for every order, they appeared increasingly focused on protecting economics. Sea's subsequent margin improvement only strengthened that narrative.

The latest three months tell a similar story. Prices are still rising across most markets, though the source of inflation has shifted. Previously, higher prices came from increases in post-discount listing prices. Today, the lift is coming less from what sellers ask and more from what platforms give away. Vouchers are fading into the background, and consumers are paying a little closer to sticker price.

Yet the two are following different scripts. Shopee has kept headline prices largely unchanged while quietly pulling back on coupon subsidies, allowing realised selling prices to climb. TikTok Shop has also eased promotional intensity, but softer delivery charges have absorbed much of the impact, leaving consumer prices comparatively contained. This has resulted in Shopee appearing less often as the cheapest platform relative to TikTok Shop. But the gap is not wide and hence it does not represent any major change in competitive intensity. While growth focus remains - we are seeing attempts to keep margins intact.

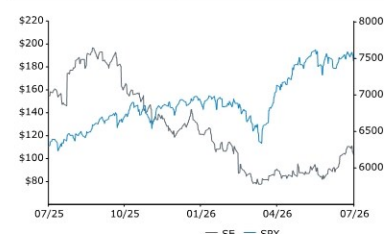
Investment Implications

Overall, with most pricing changes modest and still directionally upward, we continue to view the market backdrop as supportive of margin stability. Maintain Outperform

Close Date	17 Jul 2026			
SE Close Price (USD)	104.05			
Price Target (USD)	150.00			
Upside/(Downside)	44%			
52-Week Range	199.30/77.05			
SPX	7,457.69			
FYE	Dec			
Div Yield	NA			
Market Cap (USD) (M)	63,729			
EV (USD) (M)	56,901			
Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	(18.4)	14.5	(14.3)	(37.7)
SPX (%)	8.9	0.5	7.5	18.4
Relative (%)	(27.4)	14.0	(21.8)	(56.1)

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Adjusted EPS	F24A	F25E	F26E	Financials	F24A	F25E	F26E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	F24A	F25E	F26E
SE (USD)	0.77	2.71	3.39	Revenues (M)	16,820	22,938	27,489	--	Adjusted P/E (x)	134.8	38.4	30.7
				Operating Earnings (M)	662.21	1,985	2,363	--	EV/EBITDA (x)	29.0	16.6	15.7
				Net Earnings (M)	447.88	1,611	2,053	--	P/Sales (x)	3.7	2.7	2.3
									EV/Sales (x)	3.4	2.5	2.1

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our [Global Research Disclosure Website](#).

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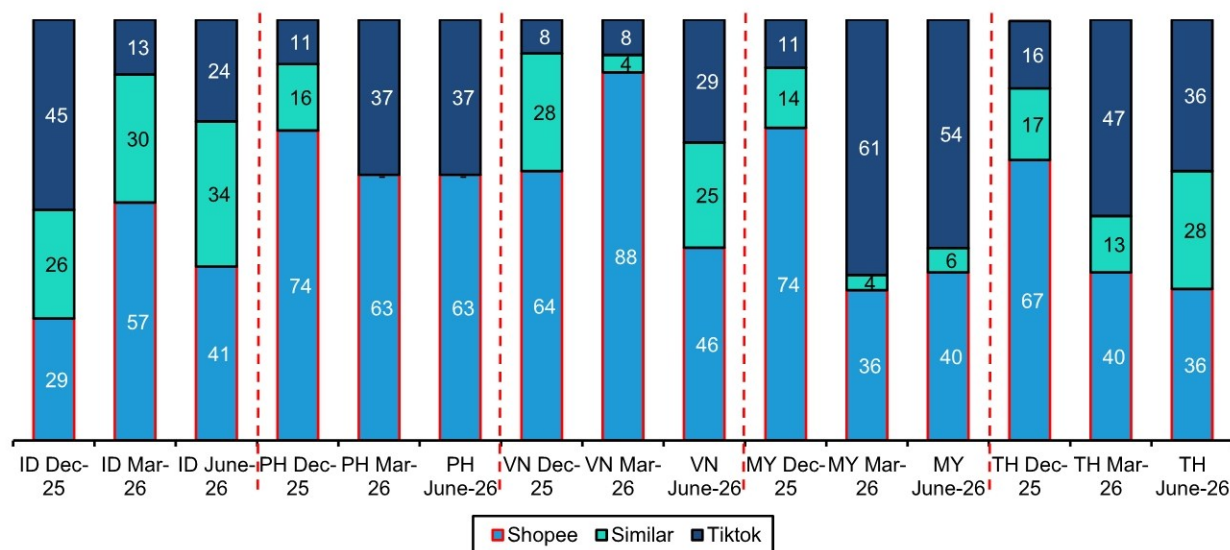
DETAILS

Price increases continued across ASEAN this quarter, although the drivers differed from those observed previously. Shopee kept listing prices broadly stable across markets, generally within a range of -5% to +5%, but sharply reduced coupon discounts, resulting in higher final consumer prices. This approach should be margin accretive, even if it comes at the expense of some headline growth. TikTok Shop took a different route. While it also reduced coupon discounts, the impact was largely offset by lower delivery charges paid by consumers, helping limit increases in final prices across several markets. Listing discounts meanwhile recovered after declining last quarter, potentially reflecting improving merchant confidence as concerns around elevated fuel costs eased.

These differing approaches translated into changes in relative competitiveness. The proportion of products priced cheaper on Shopee declined across all markets in our sample, reflecting the sharper increase in final prices on the platform. However, this does not appear to signal a meaningful shift in competitive intensity. Last quarter, we highlighted the platforms' ability to pass through higher costs, particularly fuel-related increases linked to the MENA situation. The latest data suggests a continuation of that trend, albeit through different mechanisms. After nearly two years of persistent price declines, Sea appears increasingly focused on balancing growth with margin improvement, while TikTok Shop remains more focused on protecting consumer value by offsetting lower vouchering with reduced delivery charges.

Despite the narrowing of its pricing advantage, Sea remains more competitively priced than TikTok Shop across most ASEAN markets in our sample. Vietnam was the only exception, where a sharper cut in TikTok Shop prices allowed it to regain some ground, although Sea remains more competitive overall. Across the rest of the region, higher price increases on Shopee shifted relative pricing modestly in TikTok Shop's favour, but Sea remains either the cheaper platform or broadly at parity in most markets. Overall, the data points to rational pricing behaviour rather than any meaningful escalation in competition.

EXHIBIT 1: **Mix of products cheaper in a platform**



ID: Indonesia; PH: Philippines; VN: Vietnam; MY: Malaysia; TH: Thailand

Source: Bernstein Proprietary survey, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

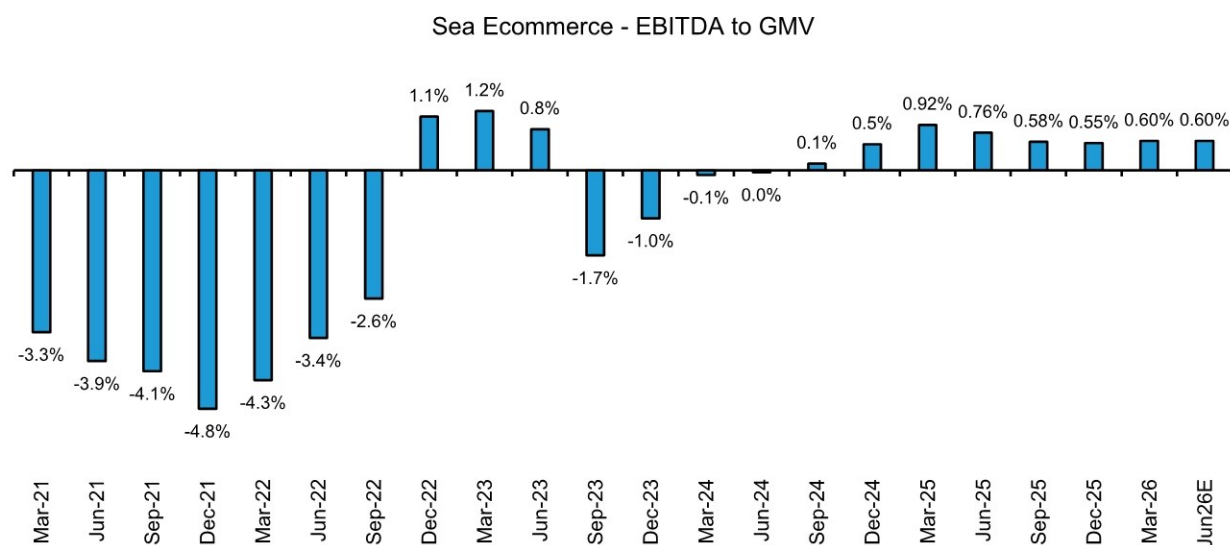
EXHIBIT 2: April- June 2026: Change in final product prices was in the -5% to 30% range for Sea compared to -10% to 40% for TikTok shop

Shopee vs TikTok shop - Change in final product prices						
Shopee	Product price before discount	Listing discount	Listing Price	Coupon discount	Delivery charges	Final product price
Indonesia	13%	24%	6%	-11%	-6%	6%
Malaysia	-4%	-2%	-4%	-6%	-2%	-3%
Vietnam	1%	12%	-2%	-30%	-2%	15%
Thailand	16%	29%	5%	-17%	0%	30%
Tik Tok Shop	Product price before discount	Listing discount	Listing Price	Coupon discount	Delivery charges	Final product price
Indonesia	15%	26%	10%	-33%	-34%	10%
Malaysia	-5%	14%	-16%	-49%	-32%	-5%
Vietnam	-1%	18%	-8%	-1%	-1%	-8%
Thailand	10%	-11%	17%	-100%	-10%	38%

Source: Bernstein Proprietary survey, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

ECOMMERCE MARGINS

E-commerce margins at Sea Ltd have improved materially over the years, but have largely remained within a similar range over the past few quarters (September to March). This plateau reflects a deliberate choice to prioritise growth, with investments accelerating in logistics and customer acquisition. The key concern has been whether margins could deteriorate further, particularly if TikTok Shop adopts a more aggressive stance. However, both our view and market consensus are that margins should remain resilient despite ongoing investments. Recent price increases also suggest there may be scope for modest margin expansion ahead.

EXHIBIT 3: Sea Ltd : Ecommerce margins (EBITDA to GMV ratio)


Source: Company Data, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

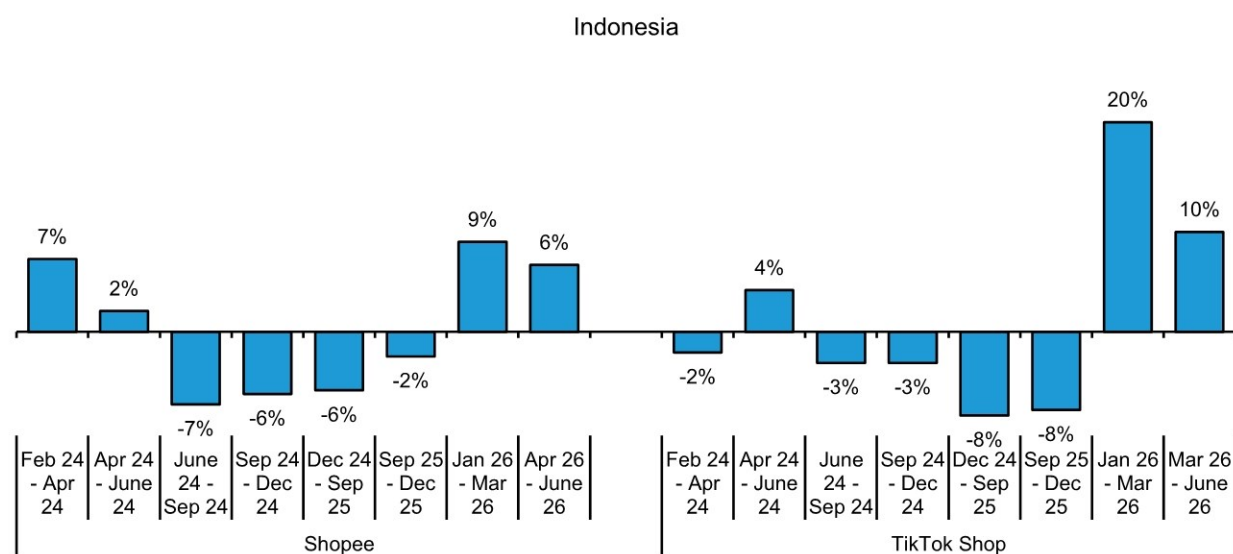
APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 4: **April - June 2026: Coupon discount and delivery charges form a very small part of the original prices, while listing discounts majorly dominate the price trends**

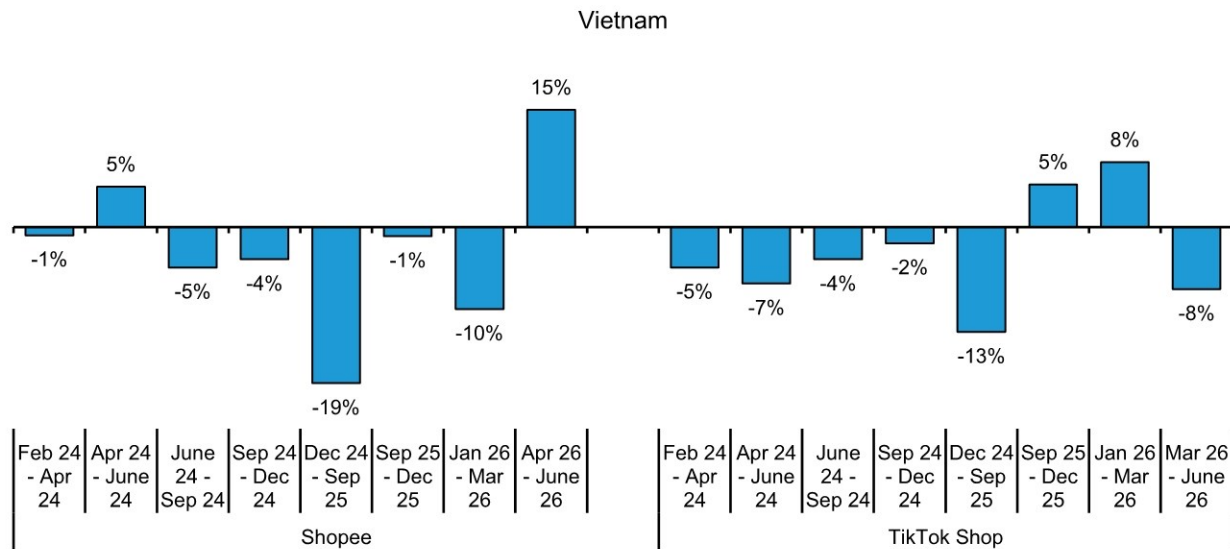
Weight of individual components in the original product price						
Shopee	Product price before discount	Listing discount	Listing Price	Coupon discount	Delivery charges	Final product price
Indonesia	100%	-41%	59%	-1%	2%	59%
Malaysia	100%	-43%	57%	-14%	13%	55%
Philippines	100%	-44%	56%	-6%	6%	56%
Vietnam	100%	-22%	78%	-24%	11%	65%
TikTok Shop	Product price before discount	Listing discount	Listing Price	Coupon discount	Delivery charges	Final product price
Indonesia	100%	-35%	65%	-3%	3%	65%
Malaysia	100%	-42%	58%	-12%	7%	53%
Philippines	100%	-39%	61%	-7%	7%	61%
Vietnam	100%	-30%	70%	-10%	10%	70%

Source: Bernstein Proprietary survey, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

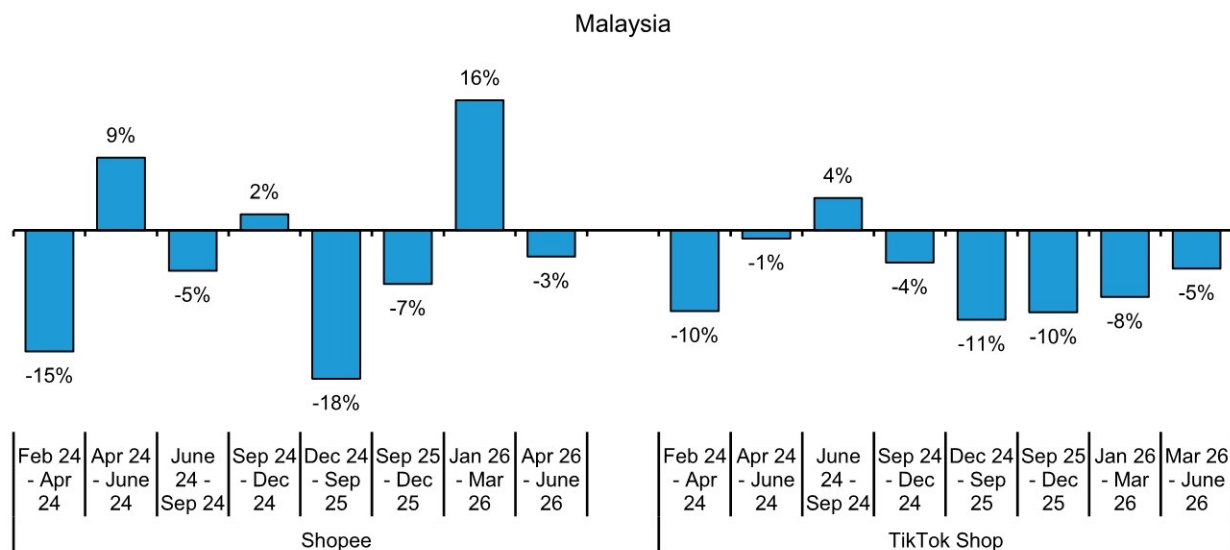
EXHIBIT 5: **Indonesia - Average change in final prices for Shopee and TikTok shop**



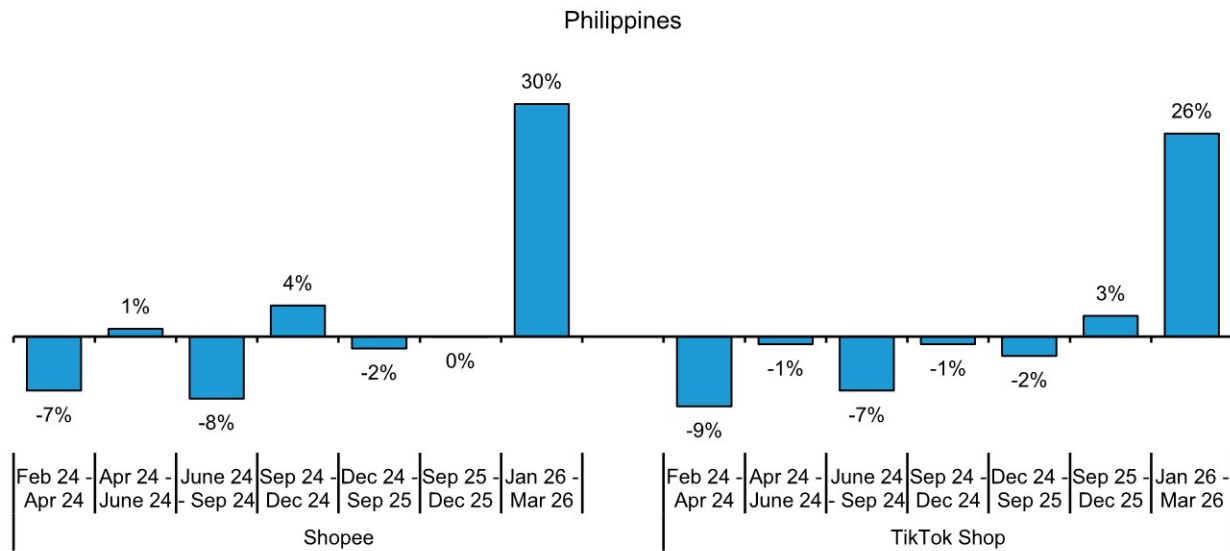
Source: Bernstein Proprietary survey, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 6: **Vietnam - Average change in final prices for Shopee and TikTok shop**

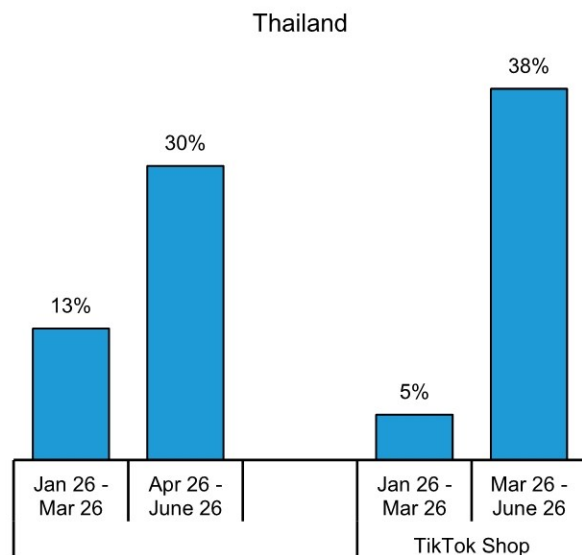
Source: Bernstein Proprietary survey, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 7: **Malaysia - Average change in final prices for Shopee and TikTok shop**

Source: Bernstein Proprietary survey, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 8: **Philippines - Average change in final prices for Shopee and TikTok shop**

Source: Bernstein Proprietary survey, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 9: **Thailand - Average change in final prices for Shopee and TikTok shop**

Source: Bernstein Proprietary survey, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 10: **Sea Limited - Financial Summary**

P&L (US\$ mn)	CY23	CY24	CY25E	CY26E
Ecommerce GMV	78,620	100,702	127,374	156,577
Take rate (%)	10.2	11.0	11.6	12.0
Digital Entertainment gross booking	1,794	2,149	2,949	2,911
Financial services TPV	29,204	37,094	55,200	74,073
Income Statement				
Revenue				
Digital Entertainment services	2,172	1,911	2,409	2,682
Ecommerce	9,001	12,415	16,571	20,750
Digital Financial services	1,759	2,368	3,792	3,857
Others	131	126	167	200
Consolidated revenues	13,064	16,820	22,938	27,489
Revenue growth (%)	4.9	28.8	36.4	19.8
Gross profit	5,834	7,205	10,244	12,069
Operating Income	225	662	1,985	2,363
Operating income margin (%)	1.72	3.94	8.65	8.60
Digital Entertainment	1,178	979	1,184	1,363
Ecommerce	(550)	(139)	581	606
Financial services	490	657	973	1,135
Others/unallocable	(893)	(835)	(713)	(741)
Adjusted EBITDA	1,185	1,962	3,437	3,633
Pre-tax income	432	779	2,281	2,763
Tax	263	321	651	691
Net income	151	448	1,611	2,053
PAT margin (%)	1.2	2.7	7.0	7.5
EPS (basic) - US\$/share	0.3	0.8	2.7	3.4
Outstanding shares (mn)	599	599	599	599
ROE	2.3	5.3	15.2	15.4
Balance Sheet				
Shareholders Funds	6,594	8,372	10,608	13,349
Debt+convertible	3,368	3,007	1,819	380
Cash flows				
Operating cash flow	2,080	3,277	1,989	1,468
Capex	(258)	(322)	(400)	(400)

Source: Company Data, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	17 Jul 2026	Price Target	TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing Price		Rel. Perf.	Cur	2024A	2025E	2026E	2024A	2025E	2026E
SE (Sea Ltd)	O	USD	104.05	150.00	(56.1)%	USD	0.77	2.71	3.39	134.8	38.4	30.7
SPX			7,457.69									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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We value Sea Ltd at a target price of \$150 using DCF valuations (11.5% discount rate, 2% terminal growth and explicit forecasts until CY35). Revenue and EBITDA growth built in our DCF model from CY24-CY35E are 10%/10% CAGR.

RISKS**Sea Ltd**

Sea Ltd has significant dependence on one game - FreeFire, hence a moderation in active user base as they move to other games is a key risk. In the ecommerce business inability to increase take rates and elevated S&M expenses as competition fights back to retain share are key risks. In the DFS segment, while it will scale up its payment wallet, we see risk from an inability to scale up its lending book and other services which is where we believe that profitability is higher.

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The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

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- Underperform: Stock will trail the performance of the market index by more than 15 pp

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Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – common stocks

The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, and the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

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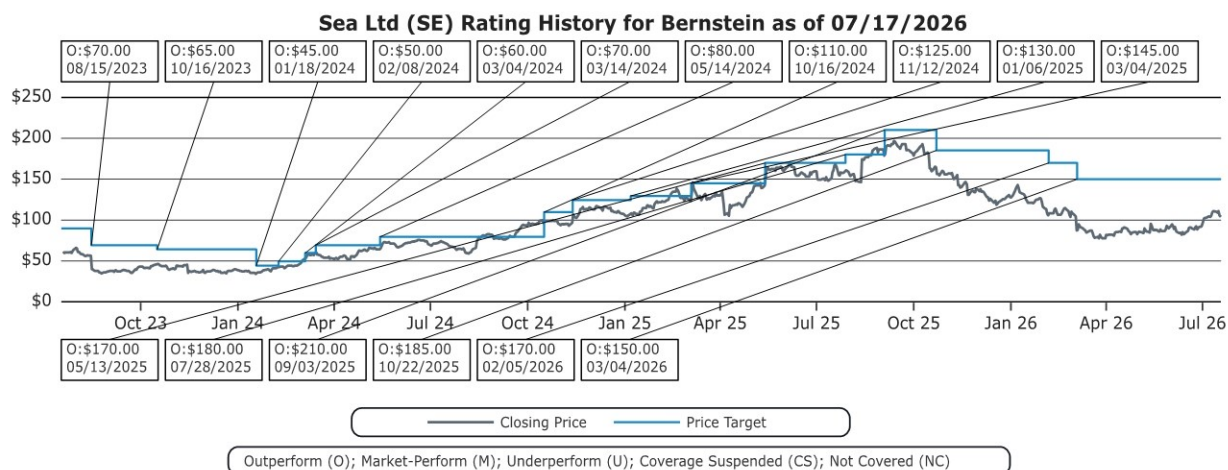
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Outperform	BUY	51.2%	15.3%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.8%	16.2%
Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

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